

ing corridors become high-demand luxury zones. But unlike the ultra-luxury segment that is mostly untouched by price movements, the second rung of the luxury market is more price sensitive.

Mangla of M3M notes a moderation in residential real estate. The pace of growth in prices is the first indicator. Luxury high-end property is still growing at 10-15% while a robust mid-segment is expected to grow at 12-15% in the next two-three years.

NO TO LUXURY ENCLAVES

Hiranandani does not believe in exclusive luxury enclaves. "In our

Pacific Home Attainability Index persistent challenges to affordable or accessible housing across the region.

Affordable or accessible housing is defined as property priced at five times the median annual household income. But in India, with a more distributed land profile and aspirational buying of houses, a sliver of lifestyle-driven luxury has entered even small towns.

According to Ashwinder Singh, President of the Confederation of Indian Industry's Real Estate Committee, "The 100 new or revived airports and the phenomenal march of

A global and contemporary lifestyle was the demand. A three- to 3.5-bedroom format seemed just right to meet the demand and the Lohias launched 175 low-rise townhouses in a linear format within a gated community. About 20 were pre-sold even before the marketing campaign was to begin in early August. He expects to sell another 60-70 as soon as the campaign breaks as doctors, chartered accountants, businessmen and city elite queue up to buy modern lifestyles at prices a notch above existing values. Many from joint families bought to disaggregate and become nuclear families, living close by but independent of each other. Some rich families from neighbouring smaller towns buy for children who are students in the city.

Lohia believes he just has to get the basics right. He has taken workers from the NCR to Moradabad to be retrained, and made them visit Sobha Developers' sites to see examples of good workmanship. His team even travelled to Dubai. His effort was to "create or achieve a level of quality that was on a par with that in South East Asian cities like Bangkok or Singapore."

Ultimately, it is a story about aspiration and resilience, combined with the ability to pay for the conveniences. Many bought for the lifestyle. But many also bought to declare their social standing. As IT layoffs mount in cities like Bengaluru and Gurugram, the middle-income evergreen sector is the first to show signs of stress.

"Even in the overheated Gurugram market, where luxury property prices have doubled in three years, sales have gone from frantic earlier to stable," says Raina from Cushman. Luxury sector sales have slowed down and so have the launches. Whether that remains a blip, only time will tell. **BT**

LUXURY HIGH-END REAL ESTATE IS GROWING AT 10-15% WHILE A ROBUST MID-SEGMENT IS EXPECTED TO GROW 12-15% IN THE NEXT TWO-THREE YEARS

integrated townships across Powai, Thane, and now Panvel, we consciously design a balanced housing mix—ranging from mid-income to premium and luxury segments—to cater to diverse lifestyle aspirations and create inclusive communities. Early adopters often include investors, professionals, and aspirational buyers drawn by infrastructure growth, integrated living, and future potential in terms of capital appreciation. End-users typically follow as social infrastructure matures—such as schools, retail, entertainment, and healthcare—transforming the township into a vibrant, self-sustained ecosystem."

While luxury in premium markets makes the headlines, the Urban Land Institute notes in its 2025 Asia

the road network across the Indian hinterland offered hope to displaced buyers from large cities. Aspiration, affordability and accessibility, were all met in smaller cities, where land was still cheaper."

SMALL-TOWN INDIA

Matching these was reverse migration, buoyed by infrastructure bridges so that even global centres of excellence were looking at these moderately priced cities. Piyush Lohia of Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh, agrees. As an influential business family in the brass and handicrafts city, the Lohias owned over 200 acres of land, purchased over a period of time. A survey revealed the need for formal housing and Lohia spotted the opportunity.